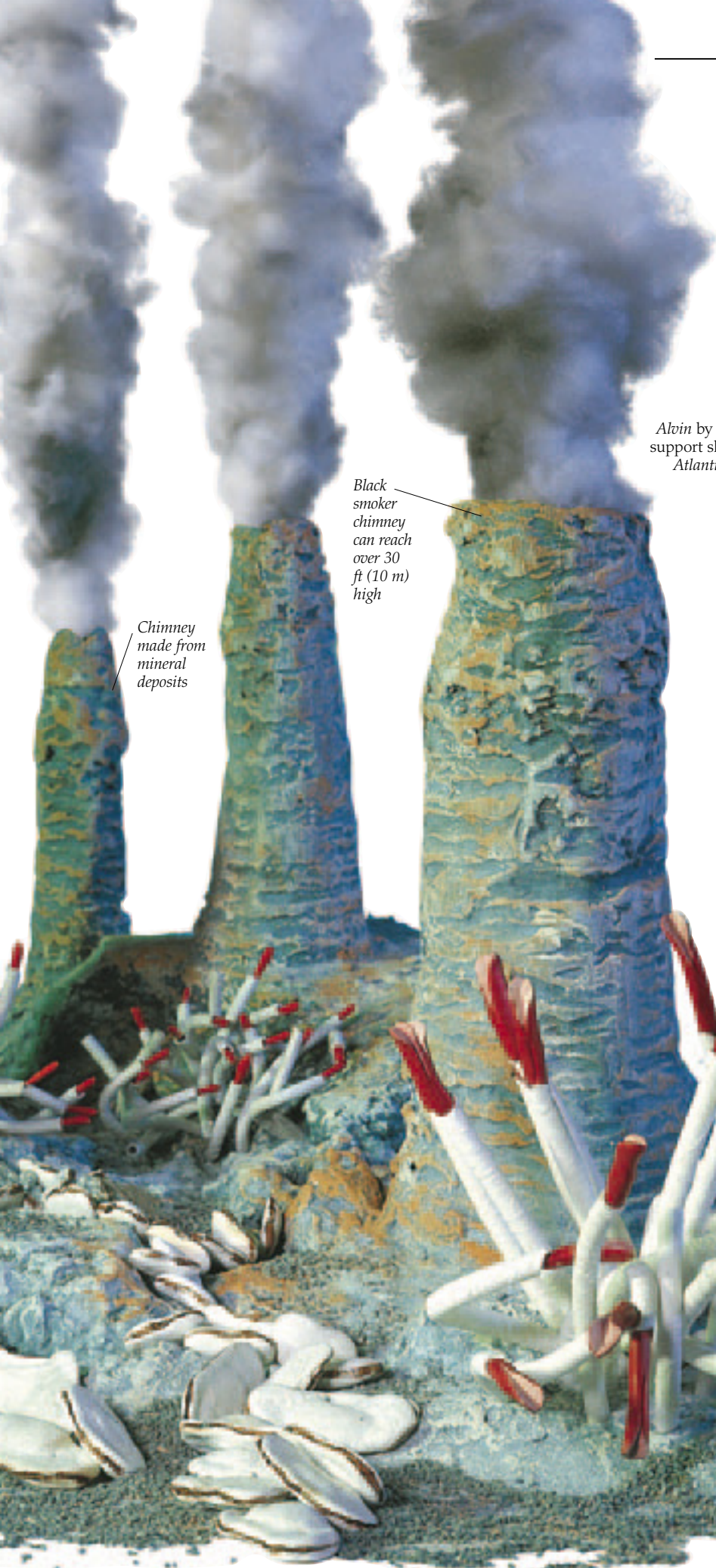




Chimney
made from
mineral
deposits

Black
smoker
chimney
can reach
over 30
ft (10 m)
high

Alvin by the
support ship,
Atlantis II

Deep-sea fish photographed
from *Alvin* near a vent on
the Mid-Atlantic Ridge



CHAMPION SUBMERSIBLE

The US submersible, *Alvin*, was the first to take scientists down to observe marine life near the Galapagos vents in the east Pacific in the 1970s. Since then, *Alvin* has completed many dives to vents around the world to depths of 12,500 ft (3,800 m). Other submersibles that have dived on vent sites include the French *Nautilus* (pp.54–55) and the Russian *Mir I* and *II*.

VENT COMMUNITIES

This model shows the vent communities in the eastern Pacific, where giant clams and tube worms are the most distinctive animals. Vents in other parts of the world have different groups of animals, such as the hairy snails from the Mariana Trench and eyeless shrimps from vents along the Mid-Atlantic Ridge.

Tube worm
can grow to
10 ft (3 m) long

Giant tube
worm has
bacteria inside
its body, which
provides the
worm with
food